top levels of command as “cold warriors.” They radiated warmth and extraordinary appreciation for Israel and the Israelis for the miracle they had created in the Middle East, their courage, their creativity and craftiness, and their manning of one of the more important outposts for American interests.

The sense of solidarity and intimacy that they felt with us sometimes made for some awkward situations. For example, in casual conversation over a few beers, they would tell jokes with just a hint of anti-Semitism; when I said to them, “Hey, guys, you’re crossing the line!” they would answer, smiling, “You’re Israelis, it’s not like you’re typical Jews.” They had to be told that Israelis and Jews were one and the same. It wasn’t that they didn’t understand this per se, but in their world the overlaps and nuances between Israeli and Jewish identity were not so clear.

Throughout my tenure as director of the Mossad (1989–96), I made every effort to preserve the Mossad’s role as an asset for the CIA. In the overall balance, it was very difficult to maintain equality between the benefits that each side reaped from the other. The gap between a world power with almost unlimited capabilities and a “minipower” like Israel made this kind of balance impossible. However, and in all modesty, I would like to mention that then-deputy director (later director) of the CIA George Tenet came to Israel specifically to bid me farewell and to grant me a medal on behalf of the CIA. For me, this was proof that I had met expectations—first of all my own, but also those of our closest friend.

Cyber Warfare—A New Definition for an Old Profession

The term *cyber* burst into our lives two decades ago and brought about profound changes in the world. The discipline of cyber intelligence had actually existed in the Israeli intelligence community since the state’s early years, under other names, and with much less potential for harm to the enemy than today. The envelope that defines the threat and the response was always dependent on the technologies’ limitations. From the outset, the Israeli intelligence community has generally been able to maximize its range of operational capabilities within the limits of technology. As technology developed over the years, so did the scope of capabilities and operations. Today the world is at a point where the potential cyber threat rivals, and perhaps even surpasses, the potential threat of other nonconventional weapons. Let’s take a look at how it all began and how it evolved.